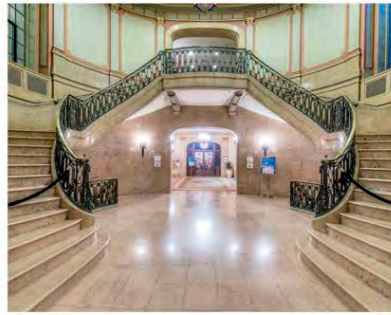




△ OPULENT INTERIOR

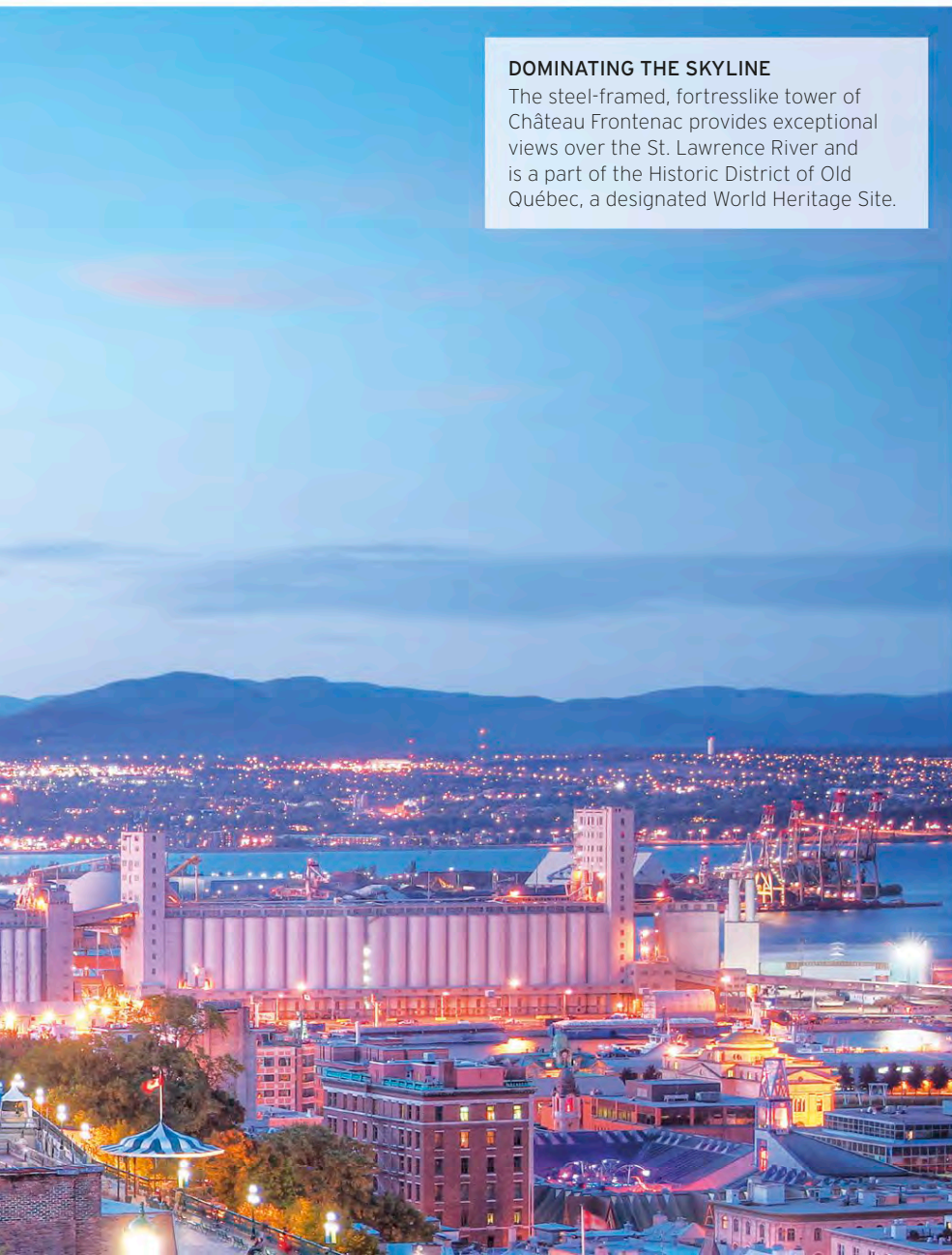
The grand double staircase within Château Frontenac is made of marble and wrought-iron banisters. The surrounding walls are painted a pale yellow-green color called eau de nil after its resemblance to the waters of the River Nile.

◁ COPPER ROOF

Château Frontenac's steeply pitched roofs and small dormer roofs are covered with copper, which has weathered to give it a distinctive green shading.

DOMINATING THE SKYLINE

The steel-framed, fortresslike tower of Château Frontenac provides exceptional views over the St. Lawrence River and is a part of the Historic District of Old Québec, a designated World Heritage Site.



Biltmore House

A French Renaissance-style mansion that, when built, was the world's largest residence

The Gilded Age (1870–1900) was a period of rapid economic growth and conspicuous wealth in the US. None came wealthier than George Washington Vanderbilt II, whose childhood visits to Asheville, North Carolina, inspired him to build his own summer estate there. Designed by New York architect Richard Morris Hunt, Biltmore is modeled on the French châteaux of the Loire Valley, as well as the Rothschild-owned Waddesdon Manor in England. With 179,000 square ft (16,600 square m) of floor space, the 250-room, four-story house has steeply pitched roofs, turrets and towers, and sculptural ornamentation. Construction began in 1889 and continued into 1896. No expense was spared, as Biltmore was designed for an opulent, gilded age.



△ WINTER LUXURY

The octagonal Winter Garden is surrounded by stone archways and covered with a ceiling of sculpted wood and glass. The centerpiece is a sculpture and fountain entitled *Boy Stealing Geese*, created by the Austrian-born Karl Bitter.